Preset Maestro

Quick guide • Draft for feedback • 20 October 2026

Preset Maestro gives you quicker access to your Fractal sounds and more ways to organise and explore them. Jump to a preset, recall favourite scenes, add tags and find where you use an amp model. This guide follows version 1.2.29; see the full manual for device support and detailed workflows.

1. Connect your Fractal

Use the connection appropriate to your model. FM9 and Axe-Fx III can use USB MIDI. For standard MIDI, including FM3, use a MIDI interface: interface **Out** to Fractal **In**, and Fractal **Out** to interface **In**. Both directions are needed for selections and readback.

Open **Config → MIDI Connection**, choose the matching **MIDI In** and **MIDI Out**, then click **Connect**. Follow the first-time **Sync device** prompts to read saved presets, scenes and amp information. This can take several minutes. Keep the **Default** profile while learning the app. Available reads and catalogues depend on the model; FM9 has the most complete support.

Under **Config → Device for this profile → Manage devices**, check that **MIDI channel**, **Display offset** and **Scene CC#** match the Fractal. Save any sound edits you want to keep before trying other presets.

2. Jump straight to a preset

Open **Preset Sender**, type the preset number, then press **Enter** or click **SEND**. For example, entering **287** takes you straight to preset 287. Use **Backspace** to correct a digit or **CLR** to clear the number. Keep the app in the foreground.

To send without pressing Enter, enable **Auto-send full numbers** under **Config → Entry Options**. Enter a short number such as 7 as **007** on a 512-slot device, or **0007** on a 1,024-slot device. The app waits for all three or four digits before sending. On **Favorites**, auto-send always uses three digits for the favourite slot number.

SENT confirms the command was sent. Check the Fractal's display and play to confirm the result.

3. Keep your favourite scenes ready to play

Open **Favorites** and click **New**. Choose the **Preset** and **Scene**, give the favourite a useful name, and click **Save**. On a connected FM9, **Use Current** fills in its current preset and scene; check the numbers before saving.

To recall a favourite, double-click its row. You can also type its **Slot** number on **Favorites** and press **Enter**, or enter that slot number through your configured MIDI controller. Favourite 7 might recall preset 287, scene 3. A single click inspects a row without loading it.

4. Organise your sounds with tags

Tags describe qualities you choose after playing: *single coils*, *humbuckers*, *warm*, *tight bass*, *slapback echo* or *wide stereo*. Give a sound as many useful tags as you need.

In a favourite's editor, type a tag in **Tags**, press **Enter**, then **Save**. You can also tag presets and scenes without making favourites. Within a profile, a scene's tags are shared between the scene browser and favourites pointing to it.

Use the search box to choose tags or search by name. **All tags** requires all selected tags; **Any tag** accepts at least one. Ordinary text searches still all have to match. Search, sort and browsing do not load sounds or change favourite slot numbers.

5. Browse presets and scenes

Open **Presets and scenes**. Choose **Presets** to inspect saved presets, their scenes and amp information, or **Scenes** to browse scenes across the collection. Double-click a result, or select it and use **SEND** or **Go to**. A scene action loads its preset first when needed.

To add tags, open a preset's details and select a scene, then choose **Add tag / Edit tags**. With no scene selected, that action edits preset tags. Choose **Save tags**. Close the pane with **× Close** or **Escape**.

6. Find amps by names you recognise

Open **Amps** to find the real amp behind a Fractal model name. Search by manufacturer, real amp name or Fractal name. Select an amp family, tick its variations under **Use in search**, and click **Show presets for…**. Open a matching preset and choose a scene to try.

Choose **Used in my presets** to revisit your collection, or **Not used in my presets** for ideas. The unused list needs a complete device scan and matching amp catalogue. It describes whole amp families, and includes every saved Amp channel when deciding whether a model is used. The browser does not insert amps into presets.

7. Use a MIDI pad or foot controller

Configure the controller to send MIDI notes for digits and commands such as **SEND**. In **Config → MIDI Connection**, select its input under **Thru In(s)**. Under **Entry Options**, enable **MIDI note entry**, then open **MIDI note mapping → Configure…** to match note numbers to actions.

Use it to enter preset numbers on **Preset Sender**, or favourite slot numbers on **Favorites**. Select only one input route per controller; duplicate routes can send each press twice. Match the per-input channel filter to the controller. Other messages can pass through using their original MIDI channel and assignments.

8. Keep different projects and devices organised

Use **Config → Profiles → Manage Profiles** to create, copy or switch profiles. Each keeps its own favourites and tags. Several profiles can share the same device while using different organisation.

Under **Config → Device for this profile → Manage devices**, give each physical unit a recognisable name and assign the intended device to each profile. Check the actual MIDI connection when changing units.

After saving changes on the Fractal, use **Resync Presets** to refresh the collection or **Resync Scenes** for one preset. FM9 also checks observed saved changes automatically; changes made offline or missed between polls can still need a manual refresh. Browse saved information while disconnected, and connect when you want to load sounds.